

Pactshift

Scope changes your clients can approve

A client asks for more. Pactshift turns the request into an explicit choice about budget or deliverables, then updates the project everyone agreed to.

The screenshot displays the Pactshift interface for a project request. On the left, under 'The request, in their words', a client asks for Spanish versions of six core website pages. Below this, 'Against the agreed scope' section explains that adding a new language to an English-only baseline requires a 16-hour exchange for the 12-hour request. A table shows the 'Core website build' with six English pages. On the right, 'A fair way forward' section provides options: 'Confirmed effort (hours)' is 12, 'Extra calendar days if added' is 2, 'Add budget' is \$1,500 (12h x \$125/h + 2 days), 'Exchange scope' is +\$0 (replacing the resource library), and 'Decide later' is unchanged.

Option	Value
Confirmed effort (hours)	12
Extra calendar days if added	2
Add budget	\$1,500
Exchange scope	+\$0
Decide later	Unchanged

Actual application. Fictional demonstration project.

For founders and delivery leads at small web and design agencies.

A focused workflow alongside their existing project tools.

A familiar negotiation.

A clearer agreement.

The buyer and the trigger

The initial buyer is the owner or delivery lead of a 2-15 person web or product design agency. A fixed-fee project is already underway. The client asks for another language, integration, page, or revision before delivery. The team needs to agree on the consequence before starting the work.

The friction

Email and project boards can capture a request without changing the underlying commercial agreement. The agency may absorb work, negotiate a separate fee, or exchange planned deliverables. Upwork documents these same responses to scope creep. That establishes a recognizable practice, not proven demand for this product. [1]

A focused competitive position

Existing option	What Pactshift must earn
ScopePilot: contract analysis and change orders, EUR 4.99/mo [2]	Analysis alone is already inexpensive.
ScopeGuardian: cited analysis and approvals. Post-beta \$99/mo + 5% of changes, percentage fees capped at \$5,000/year [3]	Citations and approval links alone do not differentiate.
ScopeApproval: approvals and receipts, \$27 / \$47 / \$97 [4]	The full decision must be fast and clear.

The differentiation hypothesis

Pactshift makes an accepted scope swap executable: it names the work removed, checks eligibility and capacity, adds the new deliverable, and saves the new baseline atomically. Flat subscriptions leave the approved value with the agency. This is a product focus, not a claim of category invention.

Research status: desk research only. No verified users, customers, or revenue. Vendor prices and feature claims were reviewed on 22 September 2026 and can change.

One request.

Three explicit choices.

Fictional example: Northstar Studio is delivering the Forma website. The client requests 12 hours of Spanish-language pages and supplies approved Spanish copy.

Choice	Commercial consequence	Saved project
Add	\$1,500 proposed fee 12 hours at \$125/hour 2 calendar days added	Budget: \$12,000 to \$13,500 Effort: 96h to 108h
Swap	Exchange the 16-hour resource library for 12 hours of Spanish pages	Budget: \$12,000 unchanged Effort: 96h to 92h
Defer	Continue the agreed work	Budget, date, scope unchanged

The complete workflow

The owner creates a scoped project, records the request, reviews the analysis and effort, and shares a limited client link. The client sees the options and acknowledges one. The API applies the result to the current project and records a decision receipt. Reloading preserves the new state.

Rules that protect the agreement

Only planned, unlocked work without active dependents can be swapped. The selected capacity must cover the new request. The server computes the fee. A stale baseline cannot be accepted, and repeating an accepted request cannot duplicate work. Deferral records a decision without changing the baseline.

All figures above describe the seeded demonstration. A proposed or approved fee is not money collected. Four freed hours are capacity, not revenue. The acknowledgment records a named choice, without independently verifying the signer.

Deterministic decisions. Bounded AI assistance.

Layer	Responsibility
React / Vite client	Project setup, review, client decision, receipts, settings.
Express / TypeScript API	Authentication, tenant checks, price calculation, quotas, validation and acceptance.
Firestore adapter	Durable workspace state and atomic mutation. Local JSON adapter supports a zero-credential local run.
Optional Vertex AI	Scope analysis with validated evidence citations. Disclosed rules fallback when AI is unavailable.
Optional Stripe	Hosted subscription checkout and portal. Signed, replay-safe webhooks update plan state.

The transaction is the trust boundary

Acceptance checks token expiry, request status, current baseline version, and swap eligibility. A single mutation updates scope and budget, preserves the baseline history, and appends the chained audit event. AI cannot authorize a change or set prices.

Data protection in the product

Private routes enforce the workspace owner. Sessions use HttpOnly cookies, with Secure in production, SameSite protection and CSRF checks. Public offers contain a restricted client view. Workspace export excludes credentials and share tokens. Account deletion clears the account and its sessions.

Operating boundaries

One owner per workspace. Stored projects include archives. Each project allows at most 30 requests, 100 audit events and 50 baseline versions. The workspace limit is 720,000 bytes. Hash chaining is not external notarization. No SSO, team roles, verified signatures or compliance certification. Production operation needs monitoring and a backup policy.

Simple pricing. Evidence before expansion.

Plan	USD / month	Stored projects	Analyses / month
Free	\$0	3	30
Studio	\$29	15	300
Agency	\$79	60	1,500

Proposed pricing before tax. Archived projects count toward the limit. Client approvals are included within the storage limits on page 4. No percentage fee on approved work. Stripe needs merchant configuration. Subscriptions do not collect the agency's client invoices.

A cost model with visible assumptions

At 6,000 input and 1,000 output tokens, Gemini 2.5 Flash-Lite costs an estimated \$0.001 per analysis at published rates. At the Studio allowance, a 2x contingency is \$0.60/month. Agency is \$3.00/month. These are token assumptions, not observed bills. Hosting, storage, support, processing, retries and taxes remain separate. [5]

The first commercial test

Interview ten qualified agency owners and invite five design partners to run a real change request. Measure client sharing, time to decision, repeat use, and paid continuation. Neither the interviews nor pilots are completed. Usage and actual payment will determine whether the pricing and workflow deserve expansion.

Primary sources and reproducibility

- [1] Upwork, scope negotiation guide
- [2] ScopePilot, vendor pricing
- [3] ScopeGuardian, vendor pricing
- [4] ScopeApproval, vendor pricing
- [5] Google Cloud, generative AI pricing

Code, architecture, setup, full source pack and validation playbook
Live Pactshift application

Sources reviewed 22 September 2026. Built by Shivam Gupta with AI-assisted engineering and content production. Customer and revenue validation remains outstanding.